



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*ahimsā vaidikaṃ karma dhyānamindriyasamyamaḥ d
tapo'tha guruśuśrūṣā kiṃ śreyaḥ puruṣaṃ prati e
bṛhaspatiruvāca d*

— *6976011* (Mahabharata Chapter 13), Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The verse from the Mahabharata, spoken by Brihaspati, poses a profound question about what truly benefits a person. It lists several virtues and practices – non-violence (ahimsa), Vedic rituals (vaidika karma), meditation (dhyanam), control of the senses (indriyasamyama), austerity (tapas), and service to the guru (gurushushrusha) – and then asks, "What is truly good for a person?" It is not merely a rhetorical question, but an invitation to delve deeper into the nature of dharma and what constitutes a fulfilling life.

In essence, Brihaspati is prompting us to consider the relative value of different paths. Are rituals enough? Is simply avoiding harm the ultimate goal? The inclusion of practices like Vedic rituals highlights the context of the time, but the underlying principles are timeless. Non-violence extends beyond physical harm to encompass thoughts and words, urging you to cultivate compassion in all your interactions. Sense control isn't about repression, but about mastering your desires so they don't control you. Austerity speaks to disciplined living, focusing your energies on what truly matters rather than being swept away by fleeting pleasures. And service to the guru represents the humility and openness required to learn from those who have walked the path before.

Applying this wisdom to modern life requires discernment. You might not perform Vedic rituals in the traditional sense, but you can cultivate rituals of mindfulness and gratitude in your daily routine. Non-violence can manifest as choosing your words carefully in online interactions, or actively working to dismantle systems of injustice. Sense control can involve limiting your exposure to addictive technologies or practicing mindful consumption. Austerity can be as simple as decluttering your home and your mind, focusing on experiences over possessions. And while a traditional guru may not be accessible to everyone, you can seek mentors and guides who embody the qualities you aspire to cultivate. Ultimately, the verse encourages you to engage actively in your own spiritual growth, constantly evaluating what truly nourishes your soul and leads you towards greater well-being.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Are you truly living according to the principles you believe in, or are you merely paying lip service to them? How can you translate these ancient virtues into tangible actions in your daily life today?